KERALA POLYTECHNIC • DIPLOMA CURRICULUM REVISION 2026

Theory | Semester II | 45 contact hours | 3 credits | CIE 40 / ESE 60

2183
History of Architecture — I

An illustrated introduction to prehistoric, ancient river-valley, Indian, Buddhist, Greek and Roman architecture with emphasis on context, form, materials and representative examples.

Course code	**2183**
Scheme	**2:1:0:0**
Credits	**3**
Contact hours	**45**
Self-learning	**4 / week; 60 h listed**
Type	**Theory**

OFFICIAL SOURCE DECLARATION

How this lesson was prepared

The supplied official syllabus PDF was used as the authoritative source for course information, objectives, course outcomes, CO–PO mapping, modules, topics, instructional hours, self-learning activities, assessment structure and listed learning resources. Educational explanations, examples and diagrams have been added to make the official topics learnable; they are not presented as additional official syllabus requirements.

Source file: 2183.pdf
Curriculum: Diploma Curriculum Revision 2026.
No obvious numerical inconsistency was found in the supplied course-information, module-hour or assessment tables. The source file remains authoritative.

AT A GLANCE

Course dashboard

Course dashboard	
Field	**Official information**
Programme	Architecture; Interior Design
Course code / title	2183 — History of Architecture — I
Semester / type	II / Theory
Teaching scheme	2:1:0:0 (L:T:P:R)
Contact hours / credits	45 / 3
Self-learning	4 per week; total 60 hours
Assessment	CIE 40; ESE 60
Prerequisite	Basic architectural vocabulary and visual observation; Secondary Education

STUDY METHOD

How to use this lesson

Before class

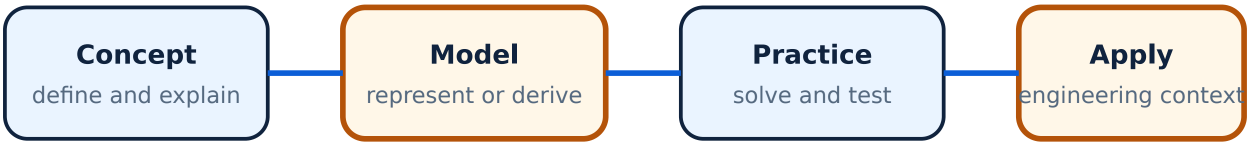
Read the topic definition and inspect the diagram. Mark unfamiliar technical words in the glossary.

During practice

Reproduce the worked example or procedure without looking at the answer. For theory topics, redraw labelled diagrams and compare classifications.

Before examination

Use the module questions, formula bank, official assessment pattern and final checklist. Treat the practice paper as preparation, not as an official question paper.



Use this cycle for every module: understand the official concept, represent it accurately, practise, and connect it to an application.

OUTCOMES AND ALIGNMENT

Objectives, course outcomes and CO–PO mapping

Official course objectives

1. Understand the evolution of architecture from prehistoric to ancient civilizations.
2. Identify architectural features, planning principles and materials of historical periods.
3. Relate architecture to climate, geography, culture, religion, society and technology.
4. Develop skills to analyze and document historical buildings and settlements.

Course outcomes

CO	Official course outcome	Bloom
CO1	Explain prehistoric and early settlement architecture with reference to materials, construction and cultural context.	Understand
CO2	Identify architectural features of Egyptian, Mesopotamian, Indus Valley, Vedic and Buddhist traditions.	Understand
CO3	Describe Greek and Roman architecture, orders, construction and representative buildings.	Understand

CO	Official course outcome	Bloom
CO4	Analyze historical buildings using architectural vocabulary, sketches and contextual comparison.	Analyze

CO-PO course articulation matrix

CO	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11
CO1	3	2	2	-	-	1	-	-	1	-	1
CO2	3	3	2	-	-	1	-	-	1	-	1
CO3	3	3	3	-	-	1	-	-	1	-	1
CO4	3	3	3	-	-	2	-	-	2	-	1

Legend: 1 = Low; 2 = Medium; 3 = High; - = No Correlation.

NOTHING OMITTED

Complete syllabus coverage

Complete syllabus coverage map

Module	Official title	Instructional hours	Major syllabus coverage
I	Prehistoric Architecture	10 L + 2 T	Paleolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Bronze Age and Iron Age architecture
II	Egyptian, Mesopotamian and Indus Valley Civilizations	10 L + 2 T	Contexts, planning, materials and representative architecture
III	Vedic and Buddhist Architecture	8 L + 2 T	Vedic settlements, Mauryan period, stupa, chaitya and vihara
IV	Greek and Roman Architecture	10 L + 1 T	Greek orders, temples, theatres and Roman construction/representative buildings

Every official module and major topic is expanded below. The wording may be grouped for teaching clarity, but no supplied syllabus item is intentionally removed.

Official representative examples and terms: The prehistoric unit includes caves, rock shelters, oval huts, settlement and burial systems, dolmens, gallery graves, passage graves, cairns, tumuli, Çatalhöyük and Stonehenge. River-valley and Egyptian study includes mortuary temples; Indus planning includes the Citadel, Lower Town, granaries and the Great Bath. The Vedic/Buddhist unit names Aryan/Vedic context, Sanchi, stambha, the Ashoka pillar at Sarnath, Karli chaitya halls and Ajanta rock-cut caves. The classical unit includes the Parthenon at Athens, the Greek orders, and

Roman structural developments. Additional representative examples and terms: tumulus (burial mound), Çatalhöyük (catalhoyuk), and granary (grain-storage building in Indus settlements) are part of the official syllabus vocabulary.

LEARNING ROADMAP

How the modules connect

Module 1
Origins & prehistory

Module 2
River civilizations

Module 3
Vedic & Buddhist

Module 4
Greek & Roman

MODULE 1

Prehistoric Architecture

The earliest built environments reveal how climate, mobility, available material, ritual and social organization shaped form.

Official hours: 10 L + 2 T | **Mapped CO: CO1** | **Bloom level: Understand**

Learning goals

- Describe Paleolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Bronze Age and Iron Age contexts.
- Recognize shelters, settlements, megaliths and early construction methods.
- Connect form to material, climate and way of life.

Key facts

- Prehistoric periods are broad cultural/technological categories.
- Archaeological evidence is partial and must be interpreted cautiously.
- Megaliths often have ritual or funerary associations.

Engineering relevance

Use the concepts to interpret technical information, communicate decisions accurately, and solve appropriately scoped problems.

Architectural history can be read as a sequence of changing responses to needs, materials, climate, beliefs, settlement and technology.

Paleolithic and Mesolithic architecture–

Paleolithic groups relied heavily on natural shelters and temporary structures, while Mesolithic life shows increasing adaptation to seasonal settlement and local resources. Study shelter type, material, climate response and settlement pattern rather than treating “primitive” as a technical explanation.

Neolithic architecture and early settlements–

Food production and more settled life supported permanent houses and village organization. Consider mud, timber, stone, thatch, compacted earth, hearths, storage and enclosure. The key architectural idea is the relationship between subsistence, settlement permanence and construction.

Bronze Age, Iron Age and megalithic architecture–

Metallurgy, trade, social organization and ritual changed construction possibilities. The syllabus requires awareness of megalithic remains and Stonehenge. Document plan/form, material, construction logic and possible cultural use while distinguishing evidence from speculation.

Architectural history can be read as a sequence of changing responses to needs, materials, climate, beliefs, settlement and technology.

MODULE 2

Egyptian, Mesopotamian and Indus Valley Civilizations

River-valley civilizations demonstrate the link between water management, centralized organization, material resources, religion, writing and urban form.

Official hours: 10 L + 2 T **Mapped CO: CO2** **Bloom level: Understand**

Learning goals

- Identify characteristic planning and monument types.
- Compare materials and construction traditions.
- Relate architecture to rivers, society, belief and administration.

Key facts

- Floodplain geography affects settlement and materials.
- Monumental architecture expresses power and belief.
- Indus urbanism is notable for planning and drainage.

Engineering relevance

Use the concepts to interpret technical information, communicate decisions accurately, and solve appropriately scoped problems.

Egyptian architecture–

Study the Nile context, religious beliefs, monumental planning, pyramids, temples, columns and axial approaches. Stone construction, mass, geometry and processions are important analytical themes. Explain how climate, afterlife beliefs and centralized labor influenced architecture.

Mesopotamian architecture–

Mesopotamian settlements developed between the Tigris and Euphrates. Mud brick, baked brick, ziggurat platforms, city walls, courtyards and temple-palace complexes respond to material availability, floodplain conditions and political-religious organization.

Indus Valley Civilization–

Harappan/Mohenjo-daro and related sites illustrate grid planning, standardized brickwork, drainage, wells, bathing and neighbourhood organization. Use plan sketches and note what the evidence supports; do not assume unknown social meanings as facts.

MODULE 3

Vedic and Buddhist Architecture

Indian architectural traditions in this module are studied through settlement, ritual, material, symbolism and spatial organization.

Official hours: 8 L + 2 T | Mapped CO: CO2 | Bloom level: Understand

Learning goals

- Recognize Vedic settlement and building ideas.
- Explain Mauryan-period contributions at an introductory level.
- Differentiate stupa, chaitya and vihara.

Key facts

- Stupa is a commemorative/ritual mound form.
- Chaitya is a prayer hall tradition; vihara is a monastic residence tradition.
- Context and ritual use matter when reading plan and elevation.

Engineering relevance

Use the concepts to interpret technical information, communicate decisions accurately, and solve appropriately scoped problems.

Vedic and early Indian architecture–

Vedic architectural ideas are approached through settlement, ritual space, materials and relationship with nature. Discuss early settlements and the role of geometry, orientation and social organization without imposing later building classifications on earlier evidence.

Mauryan architecture−

The Mauryan period is associated with stone craftsmanship, pillars, polished surfaces and early Buddhist architectural patronage. A good answer names the feature, material and cultural context, then explains its architectural significance.

Buddhist architecture: stupa, chaitya and vihara−

A stupa is organized around a mound, harmika, chhatra and circumambulatory path in common early forms. A chaitya is a worship/prayer hall, often with an apsidal end and a stupa focus. A vihara is a monastic residence organized around cells and shared space. Compare plan, use, circulation and symbolic focus.

MODULE 4

Greek and Roman Architecture

Greek and Roman architecture provides a foundation for studying orders, proportion, public buildings, materials, structural systems and urban life.

Official hours: 10 L + 1 T | **Mapped CO: CO3** | **Bloom level: Apply**

Learning goals

- Identify Doric, Ionic and Corinthian orders.
- Describe Greek temples and theatres.
- Explain Roman arches, vaults, domes, roads and aqueducts.
- Analyze representative buildings using context and construction.

Key facts

- Greek orders differ in column and entablature details.
- Roman architecture expanded the use of arches, vaults and concrete.
- A historical analysis should connect form, use and construction.

Engineering relevance

Use the concepts to interpret technical information, communicate decisions accurately, and solve appropriately scoped problems.

Architectural history can be read as a sequence of changing responses to needs, materials, climate, beliefs, settlement and technology.

Greek architecture and the three orders–

Greek architecture is studied through proportion, column-and-entablature systems and temple planning. Doric is generally more austere, Ionic is recognized by volutes, and Corinthian by an elaborate capital associated with acanthus foliage. Draw a labelled order comparison rather than relying only on adjectives.

Greek architectural orders

Order	Recognition cues	Analytical focus
Doric	Plain capital; robust character	Proportion, column and entablature
Ionic	Volute capital	Refinement and scroll form
Corinthian	Acanthus-leaf capital	Elaboration and ornament

Greek temples and theatres–

Temples organize approach, columned peristyle, cella and associated ritual setting. Theatres use topography, audience geometry, orchestra and stage-related elements. Study the relationship between structure, sightlines, acoustics, movement and civic/religious use.

Roman architecture and construction–

Roman architecture used arches, vaults, domes, concrete, roads, bridges and aqueducts to support large-scale infrastructure and public buildings. Explain how compression-based forms and repetitive construction enabled spans, circulation and services. Representative buildings may include amphitheatres, baths, basilicas and Pantheon-type domed spaces as listed/illustrated in the syllabus context.

Comparative historical-building analysis—

For a long answer, organize the analysis under context, plan, section/elevation, materials, structure, ornament, function, climate and cultural meaning. Add a small labelled sketch and state which features are observed evidence.

RAPID CALCULATION REFERENCE

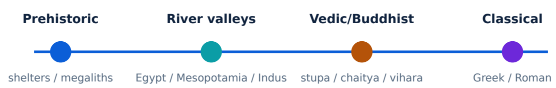
Formula bank

This course is primarily conceptual. Use the module formula cards and worked examples where a quantitative relation is naturally part of the official topic.

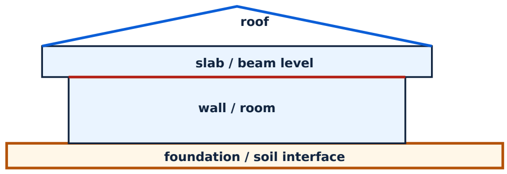
RAPID VISUAL REVISION

Diagram library

Use these labelled schematics to revise relationships and redraw them in examination answers where relevant.



Architectural history can be read as a sequence of changing responses to needs, materials, climate, beliefs, settlement and technology.



Building components are organized as a load-transfer and enclosure system from roof to foundation, while openings and finishes meet functional requirements.

OFFICIAL SELF-LEARNING

Activities and independent study

Suggested student activities for self-learning — wording retained in substance from the source PDF		
Week / group	**Official self-learning activity**	**Hours**
1–3	Comparative timeline and prehistoric shelter sketches; megalithic/Stonehenge study.	12
4–6	Egyptian/Mesopotamian/Indus site sketches, plans and material comparison.	12
7–9	Vedic/Buddhist building and settlement sketches; stupa, chaitya and vihara comparison.	12
10–12	Greek orders and building analysis; Roman construction and representative-building report.	12
13–15	Historical-building documentation, measured sketch and comparative presentation.	12

Submission tip: Keep a dated record of sketches, calculations, code/output screenshots, case-study evidence or field observations as appropriate. Use the exact activity title from the syllabus when submitting.

EXAMINATION READINESS

Assessment methodology

Theory assessment structure shown in the supplied Revision 2026 syllabus PDF.		
Component	**Official mode / duration**	**Marks / timing**
Attendance	Attendance; end of semester	5 converted marks
CA1	Self-learning activities, Module 1; by week 4	15
CA2	Self-learning activities, Module 2; by week 7	15
CA3	Self-learning activities, Module 3; by week 11	15
CA4	Self-learning activities, Module 4; by week 14	15
CA5	Series examination, two modules; 2 hours; week 8	50 raw → 20 converted
CA6	Series examination, two modules; 2 hours; week 15	50 raw → 20 converted
ESE	Written theory; 2.5 hours; end of semester	60

Series examination pattern — theory		
Part	**Question pattern**	**Marks**
Part A	4 questions total; 2 from each selected module; 1 mark each	4
Part B	6 questions total; 3 from each selected module; 3 marks each	18
Part C	4 questions total; 2 with choice from each selected module; 7 marks each	28

Part	Question pattern	Marks
Total	Two selected modules, 2 hours	50

End Semester Examination pattern — theory				
Module	**Part A**	**Part B**	**Part C**	**Module total**
1	2 × 1 = 2	2 of 3 × 3 = 6	1 set with choice × 7	15
2	2	6	7	15
3	2	6	7	15
4	2	6	7	15
Total	8	24	28	60

Important: The practice pattern below is generated for revision and must not be represented as an official examination paper.

MODULE-WISE QUESTION BANK

Questions and answers

Answers are deliberately matched to the likely mark value: definitions are concise, while longer answers use structure, comparison, formulae or diagrams.

Module I — Prehistoric

What is a megalith?+

How did Neolithic settlement differ from mobile shelters?+

Name one factor shaping prehistoric architecture.+

Module II — River civilizations

Why were rivers important to early civilizations?+

Name a characteristic of Indus urbanism.+

What is a ziggurat?+

Module III — Vedic and Buddhist

Differentiate stupa and vihara.+

What is a chaitya?+

Name one Mauryan architectural feature.+

Module IV — Greek and Roman

Name the three Greek orders.+

What is a Roman arch?+

Give two Roman infrastructure examples.+

PRACTICE ONLY

Practice Model Paper — Not an Official Examination Paper

Series examination pattern — theory		
Part	**Question pattern**	**Marks**
Part A	4 questions total; 2 from each selected module; 1 mark each	4
Part B	6 questions total; 3 from each selected module; 3 marks each	18
Part C	4 questions total; 2 with choice from each selected module; 7 marks each	28
Total	Two selected modules, 2 hours	50

End Semester Examination pattern — theory				
Module	**Part A**	**Part B**	**Part C**	**Module total**
1	2 × 1 = 2	2 of 3 × 3 = 6	1 set with choice × 7	15
2	2	6	7	15
3	2	6	7	15
4	2	6	7	15
Total	8	24	28	60

LAST-MINUTE REVIEW

Quick revision and exam checklist

Module-wise key points

1. **Module 1:** Periods, shelters, settlements, megaliths, materials and evidence.
2. **Module 2:** Egyptian monuments, Mesopotamian mud brick/ziggurats, Indus planning and drainage.
3. **Module 3:** Vedic context, Mauryan stone work, stupa/chaitya/vihara distinctions.
4. **Module 4:** Greek orders, temples/theatres, Roman arches/vaults/dom es, infrastructure and analysis method.

Exam checklist

- Write definitions before explanations.
- Use standard symbols, units, labels and terminology.
- For comparisons, use a table with a clear basis.
- For numerical work, show Given, Required, Calculation and Answer.
- For diagrams, include a title, labels and a one-line interpretation.
- Check that the answer addresses the command word: define, explain, compare, apply or discuss.

TECHNICAL VOCABULARY

Glossary

Megalith
Large prehistoric stone monument or construction.

Ziggurat
Stepped monumental platform associated with Mesopotamia.

Stupa
Buddhist commemorative/ritual mound form.

Chaitya
Buddhist prayer/worship hall tradition.

Vihara
Buddhist monastic residence tradition.

Order
A coordinated column and entablature system.

Arch
Curved compression structure spanning an opening.

Aqueduct
Infrastructure conveying water, often over distance and across terrain.

Peristyle
A row of columns surrounding a building or space.

SOURCE-SUPPORTED RESOURCES

Official learning resources

Only resources listed in the supplied syllabus PDF are included here.

- Textbook: *History of Architecture — I*, SITTTR Kalamassery.
- *History of Architecture*, Sir Banister Fletcher, CBS Publishers.
- *History of Architecture and Modern Architecture*, Satish Chandra, Agrawal Publications.
- *The Great Ages of World Architecture*, G. H. Hiraskar, Dhanpat Rai Publications.
- *Understanding Architecture: Its Elements, History and Meaning*, Simon Unwin, Routledge.
- *Indian Architecture: Buddhist and Hindu Periods*, Percy Brown, Taraporevala.